What Is Turbo Drive?

Turbo Drive is the new name for what used to be known as Turbolinks. When Turbo Drive is active, it captures every clicked link or form submission on a page, receives the response in the background, extracts the HTML `body` of the request, and replaces the existing page `body` with the new response. It also does some behind-the-scenes bookkeeping to keep the Back button working and manage caches and whatnot.

The goal is that by using Turbo Drive, page navigation is both actually faster, because large assets in the header of the page aren't reloaded, and also perceived as faster by the user because the page doesn't flicker or go blank. If you look at the `chapter_01/03` version of our page, log in with username `areader@example.com` and password `awesome` and try the "Favorite" and "Unfavorite" feature, you probably will find it quite responsive even though there is no special client-side behavior at the moment; it's just Turbo Drive redrawing the page without much flicker.

There is a downside to Turbo Drive, and this downside is the reason why a lot of Rails applications have historically chosen not to use Turbolinks. Because the browser does not see a Turbo Drive change as a full page load, it does not send page-load related events, so Turbo Drive can interfere with other JavaScript libraries or code that depend on the page-loaded or DOM-loaded events. Turbo does have its own page-load event that you can watch for called `turbo:load`, but it can be tricky to integrate with existing JavaScript libraries that depend on document load.

Turbo Drive is nice, but it's not nearly enough to build an exciting application on its own. For that, we need to turn to Turbo Frames and Turbo Streams.